



Walking in, Wang Lei, you see a tall plant with three, large, brightly-colored flowers at the top: one orange, one red, and one yellow. The flowers seem to be vibrating and shaking.

“Uh, what is that?” Wang Lei asks.

WISDOM (PERCEPTION) CHECK

On a DC 15, the Party is not surprised. On a DC 20, the Party realizes that there are multiples of such plants surrounding them, all of who appear to be ever so slightly moving closer and closer.

SWIMMING WITHOUT A SWIM SPEED

Exhausted from swimming across the Aldani Basin, Salazar, Raphael, Wukong and Vilde must make 4 Constitution saving throws. The DCs start from 11, and increase by 2 for every subsequent hour.

On a failure, they gain a level of Exhaustion. This means a universal -2 penalty to all D20 tests, and a reduction of 5 feet in their movement speed.

Failing one each, Salazar and Vilde are exhausted.

Realizing that the tri-flowers are about to attack, Hazel reacts quicker than thought. Divine energy coils around her fingers as she casts *Bless* on Wukong, Wang Lei

and Vilde. In the same breath, her illusory duplicate manifests in the cluster of the predatory flora, holding back the oncoming horde.

Vilde lunges. Her gauntlet fires with a harsh snap, a web smacking into the central yellow flower. she drives her scimitar straight into the pulsating stem. The three flowers vibrate aggressively, hissing in pain. All around her, the vines spring to life. The rogue dodges the constraining vines, only to catch a face full of orange sap. Her body goes limp from the poison, crashing to the ground.

Sensing blood, the rest of the tri-flower fronds fan out, closing in for the kill. Before they can strike, bright heat erupts through the cool jungle air. A torrent of roaring fire streaks from Raphael’s hand as the sorcerer unleashes a devastating *Fireball*.

As the spell explodes, you see the red flower on the two tri-flowers whip around, sucking in the fire. You realize that it is Resistant to Fire damage.

Recognizing the plant’s resistance to Fire, Salazar casts *Lightning Bolt*. Voltaic power surges from the wizard and strikes two of the plants, singing their stalks.

As the fight breaks out, Wukong you notice something. The sun has set. The warm light of the sun is rapidly fading from the jungle. With a sinking feeling in your stomach, you realize the sun is about to be replaced by something much, much worse.

A wave of white-hot blood rush to your head. Immense, stubborn pressure builds behind your eyes. You feel your neck thicken. Roll me a d4.

Fighting back the beast within, Wukong forces down the primal urge to surrender. He sprints to Vilde’s side. Casting *Lay on Hands*, the paladin heals Vilde and rocks her awake. Sacred radiance explodes from his palm in a blinding *Guiding Bolt*, searing the towering stalk menacing Vilde with holy fire. The sheer strain overwhelms the paladin, who collapses to his knees groaning in agony, his own vision blurring at the edge of unconsciousness.

Mason rushes behind Duo, reinforcing the rear of the camp. He holds the line against the creeping tide of tri-flowers back, ensuring that they do not reach the fragile, diseased owlbear. Princess and Thaisha plunge into the fray, holding the left flank to prevent the camp from being surrounded by all sides.



The face on Wang Lei's pauldron glows ghastly green as dark, fallen spirits of warriors in wars long past appear around him. The *Spirit Guardians* swarm the closest two plants, draining their very essence. Seizing the opening, Khan leaps forward and slashes wildly at the plants. Wang Lei's eyes, accustomed to the dark, sweeps past the melee towards shadows in the south.

WISDOM (PERCEPTION) CHECK

On a DC 15, Wang Lei spots three yuan-ti guards further out in the jungle.

Realizing the plant's resistance to fire, Hazel breaks concentration on her *Bless* and casts *Spirit Guardians* instead. The burning rabbits tear through the vines with incandescent teeth, as the cunning rabbit teleports out of the melee, to the safety of her duplicate.

The vines lash upwards, restraining Vilde. She wrestles a hand free, swinging her *Frost Brand Scimitar* and connecting with the flower stalks, nearly severing a flower. The tri-flower frond screeches as it spits its sap, spraying viscous orange and yellow liquids on Vilde. Acid burns into flesh as Vilde collapses once more into darkness.

All around them, the tri-flower fronds unload a barrage of orange poison and yellow acid. Drenched in a lethal deluge, Khan is vaporized. Wang Lei stands strong through the chemical storm, wiping the caustic sap from his face just in time to see Hazel's *Spirit Guardians* smite the plant that destroyed Khan, avenging the steed in a burst of sacred flame.

Seizing the momentum, Salazar unleashes another powerful *Lightning Bolt*. A brilliant arc of blinding lightning tears through the jungle gloom, striking straight through two of the plants.

Wukong. Your neck thickens until it disappears into your shoulders. Two jagged, ivory tusks erupt from your lower jaw, tearing through your lip. Your hair becomes stiff, black bristles that stand on end. The air feels strangely thin; you feel an overpowering, violent desire to find something to break.

Going into a frenzy, Wukong loses control as the wereboar takes hold. He lunges at Vilde with brutal ferocity, his massive tusks gouging viciously into her sides. Shocked by the sudden transformation, Raphael moves to subdue the rampaging monster that was once Wukong. Purple light dances around his fingers as he weaves a *Hypnotic Pattern* spell. Shimmering colors dance around the brute's mind, locking the lycanthrope under the sorcerer's control. Without missing a beat, he tosses a *Potion of Healing* at the fallen rogue.

Seeing the love of his life brought to the brink of death twice in moments, Mason abandons the rear guard. Dashing frantically across the camp to her side, he hacks away at Vilde's restraints before forcing a *Potion of Healing* down her throat.

At the front of the camp, Princess and Ayo help Wang Lei, making quick work of the tri-flower frond directly in front of the paladin. Now free, Wang Lei closes distance with the nearest plant, slamming his mace into it with deadly intent. Thunderous and divine energy radiate out as the weapon connects, burning the plant into cinders.

"Alright, get up!" Thaisha roars over the din of the fight, as she casts *Healing Word* to revive Vilde.

Now with breathing room, Hazel shifts her focus to containing the wereboar. The trickster moves her duplicate closer to Vilde, pouring restorative magic into her.

Rising from the threshold of death, Vilde erupts into a whirlwind of steel. Her blades flash through the now dark jungle in a flurry of slashes, shredding the tri-flower within an inch of its life before she disengages and tumbles clear out of reach of the tri-flower fronds.

The tri-flowers regurgitate their sap once more, dousing the charmed wereboar and Mason in a deadly cocktail of poison and acid. Mason collapses to the ground as the wereboar breaks free from the sorcerer's control.

Seeing the Party get overwhelmed, the yuan-ti guards began to fire *Eldritch Blasts*. Crackling lances of crimson energy dart across the foliage. One strikes directly into Hazel; she reels from the impact as her mind strains to maintain her spellwork.

Eager to get out of the fight, Raphael casts *Sorcerous Burst* and lights up the plant towering over Mason. Salazar does the same, casts *Fireball* at the yuan-ti, hoping to drive them away. The spell detonates violently, searing the trio of scaled ambushers.

Thirsty for blood, Wukong slashes wildly at the tri-flower frond, destroying it. The wereboar sinks its teeth into the plant monster, consuming it slowly.

Seeing the cleric falter under the volley of eldritch magic, Wang Lei casts *Lay on Hands*. Desperate to prevent a slaughter, Hazel bounds forward, raising her paws to cast *Speak with Plants*.

"Please!" The cleric asks. "We serve the same god. Stop fighting and join us as an ally!"

The tri-flower frond asks "What god do you serve?"

"Saleander," Hazel replies.



WISDOM (PERSUASION) CHECK

Failing a DC 15 check, the tri-flower frond is angered.

"We are going to kill you slowly," the tri-flower frond hisses, its vocalization an unnatural, rasping mockery. Before the words can fully settle, the plant spews out its deadly mix of caustic venom over the cleric. Poison and acid hit Hazel in a single wave, knocking her instantly into unconsciousness.

Vilde hurls a dagger, striking and pinning the stalk's stem. Using the attack as a distraction, she snaps her gauntlet; a line of web fires past the flower, catching Mason around the waist and yanking him out of harm's way to her.

"Enough," Raphael seethes, his voice dropping an octave. *Dissonant Whispers* overwhelms the last tri-flower frond, forcing it to flee deep into the jungle.

Pushing through the smouldering brush, Salazar reaches the fallen Mason. The wizard daps him and pulls him up, muttering "I got you, bro." Healing energy floods into the squire.

On the other side of the camp, the yuan-ti continue their assault. Another volley of *Eldritch Blasts* fly loose. Three hammer Wang Lei's chest, knocking the wind out of his lungs.

“What do we do now?” Mason asks Vilde.

“Get on Hazel,” Vilde commands. “We’ll deal with the snakes.”

Mason rushes across the bloodstained jungle, dousing Hazel with water to wash over the burning sludge and shock the cleric back to life. Ayo tosses a *Potion of Healing* to Mason, as the Party’s attention wheels towards the yuan-ti.

Trying to get out of sight, Wang Lei casts *Darkness*. Shrouding himself in dark smoke, the paladin closes distance with the yuan-ti. Vilde joins him, throwing her daggers at the trio.

“Get lost you dirty snakes!” Hazel shouts, casting *Vicious Mockery*. Sensing that the full might of the Party is barreling towards them, the yuan-ti flee.

As the battle concludes, the Party circles around the lycanthrope, who is still ripping the tri-flower frond apart. Shifting into an owlbear, Thaisha restrains Wukong. The Party pile on him, tying him down and making sure the lycanthrope does not hurt anyone else.

Ayo comes up to Hazel and says that “her potion of *Hag’s Bane* is missing”. She is confused at this, having been sure that she has brought a bottle.

“There’s another place that might have it,” She explains. “When I left the Star Goddess, I left my belongings on it. If we go to the wreckage, we might be able to find some bottles.”

The Party resolves to go rest up for the night before heading towards the wreckage the next day.

“There’s just, uh, one little problem,” Ayo continues, talking to Vilde and Raphael. “Who should I take last watch with tonight?”

“What do you mean?” Raphael asks. “Who do you normally do it with?”

“Uh, Wukong and Yandala,” Ayo replies. Behind them, Wukong growls and gnashes his teeth together, snarling and roaring.

“I’ll take last watch with her,” Raphael says. “Mason can do with you, then.”

Vilde nods, as she heads off to prepare a vegetarian meal.

Salazar, having been preoccupied with the battle, decides to relieve himself in the river. As he does his business, he realizes that they are still under watch.

You see it there, in the dark. Two yellow slits stare back at you; as it blinks, you notice that the eyelids don’t close normally. The nictating eyes of a snake greet you. Above the eyes is a painted upside down blue triangle.

The silhouette disappears back into the dark of the jungle.

Salazar goes back and warns the Party, who quickly chastise him for peeing in the river.

“It’s fine, the river’s running water,” Hazel says, tired. “Let’s just pack up and rest. We’ll just be extra vigilant tonight.” Exhausted from the long day, the Party quickly finishes their dinner and heads off to rest.

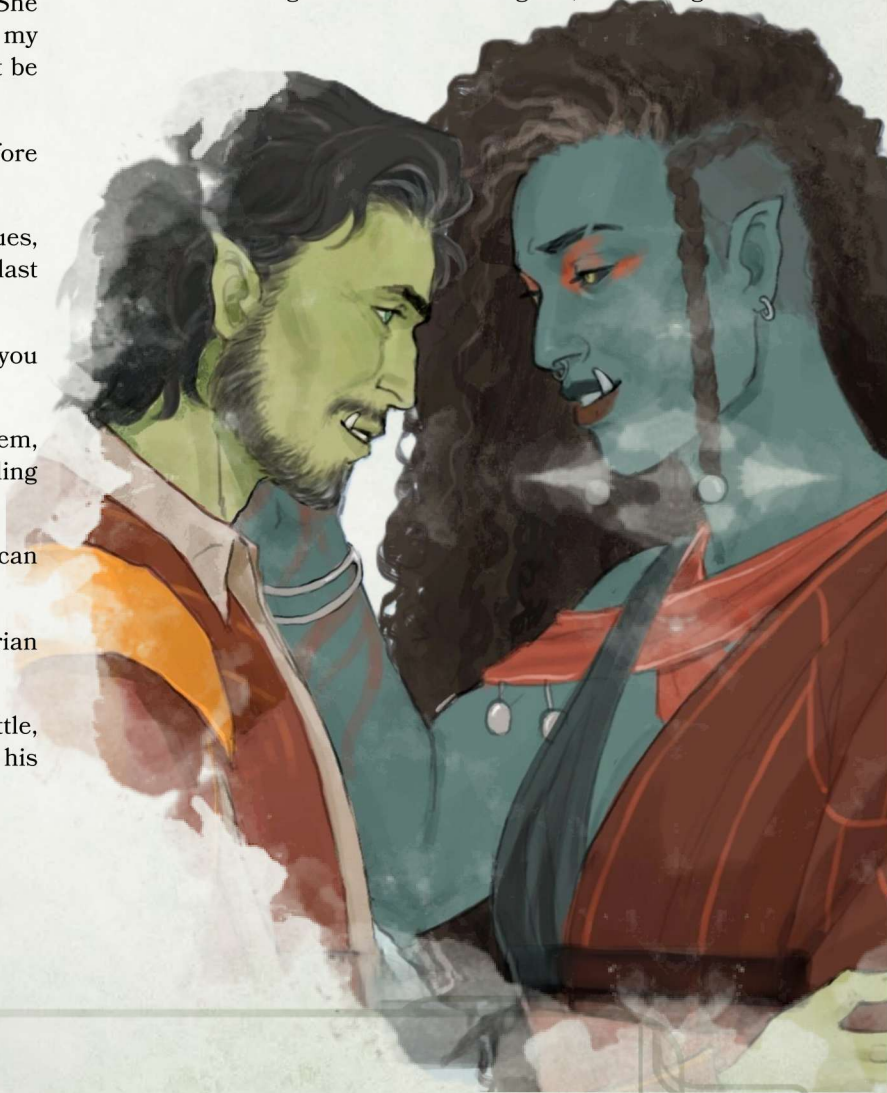
DO NO HARM

Hazel and Wang Lei. As you take up first watch, you see Thaisha come up to the both of you.

“I, uh,” Thaisha says. “saw what happened, back at the Heart. Do you want to talk about it?”

“Talk about what?” Hazel asks.

Thaisha exchanges a look with Wang Lei, who shrugs.



"You killed three people with a *Wall of Ice* spell back at the Heart," Thaisha points out. "I just... you know, wanted to make sure you were alright."

"I am fine," the cleric responds. "They're liches, anyway. They'll be back."

"Yeah, I guess," Thaisha continues. "But even if they weren't... it's okay to kill bad people, you know. Especially when they were trying to kill you."

"But we should avoid it, no?" Hazel asks. "That's what our goddess wants, as she says in *Precepts*."

"Far be it for me to quote scripture at you," Thaisha waves her hand in mock defeat. "I just wanted to make sure you were okay."

"I never did ask," Hazel continues. "What made you leave the faith?"

"My husband, he was an actor," Thaisha explains. "And, he wanted us to spend more time together, but I was always away. There is always something to do as part of the Emerald Circle. And when he told me he wanted to divorce, I asked Saleander for any help in achieving balance in my life." She meets Hazel's gaze. "And you know Saleander. She isn't about balance. She is about living life deliciously and quickly."

Hazel pauses and considers this, lost in her thoughts. As the silence reigns over them, Brownie comes up to the trio. The black dog sinks her teeth deep into Wang Lei's hand, drawing blood.

DEMON FEVER

On a DC 15 Constitution saving throw, Wang Lei's constitution holds strong. He does not contract demon fever; which would have caused him to experience fever, chills, and vomiting. His hit point maximum would have also been reduced by 1d12, and be under the Poisoned condition until the next Long Rest.

"Owl!" The paladin smacks the beast, who cackles loudly. In a iridescent shimmer, the beast blinks into the Ethereal Plane and disappears. "What was that?"

"I don't know," Hazel asks. The cleric and druid inspects the magic, recognizing that it was an *Etherealness* spell. Hazel also detects residue of fiendish magic. They decide to share the incident with the group tomorrow, who are likely knocked out already.

CIRCLE OF TRUST

Vilde and Mason take up the second watch. The squire sits nonchalantly, taking a while before he works up the courage to ask.

"M'lady," Mason asks. "During the battle, I tried to use the Locket to defend you and take some of the pain. But when I tried to invoke its magic, it faltered." The squire produces the locket, inspecting it.

The rogue lies: "It must be faulty." Her hands find the squire's as she clasps the locket in between their palms. "Listen, Mason," she continues. "All that matters is that we're safe."

CHARISMA (DECEPTION) CHECK

Succeeding a DC 15 check, Mason believes the rogue's words.

"Okay," Mason leans in and kisses the rogue's cheeks. "I just don't want anything to happen to you."

"And me to you," Vilde says.

The pair continue their watch uneventfully. The Party wakes the next day, and discussion over last night's events quickly ensue.

The Party demands answers from Wukong. The simian paladin explains that he must have contracted lycanthropy during the Battle aboard the *Brazen Bull*, where he was gored by the wereboar pirate captain.

Thaisha explains that lycanthropes are likely to go into full frenzy when both moons are full and shares that there are only three known cures - a *Wish* spell, a sufficiently powerful *Remove Curse* spell, and death. Thaisha shares that the moons have different orbits, with one having a shorter 10-day phase cycle while the other has 28-days.

Wukong talks about his experience under the spell: he describes an inner Beast that struggles for dominance and shares that he could potentially embrace it for more power at the risk of losing control. He also intuitively senses several of the Beast's behaviours: attacking nearby enemies, hunting those who are bloodied and consuming those who it has brought down.

The Party takes notes, preparing for the next possibility where Wukong hulks out.

Wang Lei, Hazel and Thaisha also share about Brownie's attack. The Party wonders why Wang Lei was targeted in particular, prompting Salazar to share his suspicions.

"Recently I had a weird sex dream," Salazar begins, prompting the girls to all share a look. "I can't say any more about the dream, but Acererak was in it. He told me something about your teddy bear." The wizard looks over at Wukong, then back at Wang Lei. "I'd like to know more, if you'll submit to a *Zone of Truth* spell."

"Sure," Wang Lei agrees. "Ask me anything."

"Where did you get the teddy bear from?" Salazar asks.

"It came to me from my patron," Wang Lei explains. "He appears in the form of a gray baby. He struck up a deal with me and asked me to free him from Raya."

"And are you?" Salazar asks. "Going to?"

"Well, undecided," Wang Lei says. "I do not like the power he has over me. We'll see how it goes. Worse come to worse, we'll just kill him."

As they ponder what this all means, Wukong recalls watching Vilde cut out Lyara Porter's tongue. Taking advantage of this opportunity, the paladin asks what she was doing over the body.

Vilde steps out of the *Zone of Truth*, refusing to answer the question. She begins to cry and be upset, prompting Mason to follow her. As she does so, Wang Lei remembers something the late Lyara Porter had said about assassins wearing a necklace similar to hers.

"Okay, maybe it's time we focus up and get out of here," Hazel points out. "We've got a long day ahead."

THE WRECK OF THE STAR GODDESS

A wooden vessel is caught high in the tree branches, broken into three chunks. It resembles a ship, but there are differences that mark it clearly as not a seagoing vessel. The stern is the lowest piece, hanging precariously by its rigging about 50 feet above ground. The middle section appears to be 15 feet higher, and the bow section is firmly wedged into a nest of branches another 10 feet above that.

The Party arrives at the Wreck of the Star Goddess, just half a day's journey away from their camp. Leading the group, Hazel keeps her eyes open to survey the ground.

"Some of us should stay down here," Wang Lei suggests. "In case anyone tries to attack us while we're in there. We could also take care of the animals."

"Great idea," Ayo agrees.

Raphael, Ayo, Vilde, Wukong and Salazar decide to climb aboard the wreck while Hazel, Thaisha, Wang Lei and Mason stays on the ground with Khan, Princess and the sick Duo. Hazel summons her duplicate on the railings of the ship, just in case.

Wukong expertly scales the trees surrounding the wreck, making it onto the ship with ease. Vilde somersaults upwards, using her web to swing onto the ship. Once aboard, the rogue helps pull Salazar, Ayo and Raphael up.

Entering the stern, you see carvings all around you. It would be hard pressed to find a section of the walls or railings that was empty.

Etched deeply into the wood are tendrils and tentacles, with dozens of stylized, unblinking eyes. You also see phrases - nothing that looks like a full sentence or paragraph - etched deeply into the wood all over the place.

As you take a look around this place, you see that this was formerly the larder. There must have used to be food here, only it is picked clean. You gather what equipment you can find, and are able to assemble an explorer's pack and a priest's pack.

LORD ANTARRA'S RAMBLINGS

Exposure to an otherworldly entity has not driven Raphael's father insane; instead, it has shown him a deeper, darker truth about reality.

1. Crimson is a cage,
2. Colors behind the light,
3. We have set the stage,
4. All that is left is White.
5. I have Opened the Gate,
6. Castellan is dead - I am beyond that state,
7. Cleansed of name, erased of face,
8. I am the Color Out of Space.

On the ground, Wang Lei begins training Mason. The pair start working on the squire's fighting stance, when they see a curious little white-furred, four-armed monkey drop down from one of the lower branches. The monkey hangs in the air, with one of its arms outstretched above it grabbing hold on a low branch. Its tusked face grins at the pair.

Noticing the beast's exposed ribcage, Wang Lei realizes that it is an undead. He raises his holy symbol, his eyes glowing golden as he calls upon his divine power to *Control Undead*. The zombie monkey falls under its spell.

On the ship, Vilde, Wukong, Salazar and Raphael begin piecing together the phrases. Vilde and Salazar point out that many of the phrases rhyme, and that it could potentially be a lead of some kind. Theories race into Raphael's head as he tries to make sense of his father's ramblings.

"There might be more phrases deeper in the ship," Vilde points out. "Let's go."

Leaping across the gap, Vilde you clear the distance into the middle section of the ship. As you land, roll initiative!

All of you watch a large ape with mottled and rotting white fur drop down into the middle of the stern.

Curved tusks protrude out from a snarling mouth as two additional arms extend from its exposed ribcage. As they approach, you see five other smaller ones, some on the large ape, others climbing down on their own make their way quickly down towards you.

“Girallon zombie!” Ayo shouts. “Run!”



WISDOM (PERCEPTION) CHECK

On a DC 15 check with disadvantage, the Party is not surprised by the girallon zombies.